

WELCOME TO:



ADA HACK 2026

PRESENTED BY



MADE POSSIBLE BY



Jane
Street



Optiver

HackathonsUK

Slideshow Overview:

Opening Ceremony

Safety Information

Mini Challenges

Challenges

Important Links



Opening Ceremony

Hoppers is the society for gender minorities in the School of Informatics at the University of Edinburgh. We aim to cultivate a welcoming, supportive, and empowering environment for gender minorities to thrive in their studies and in their futures.

Thank you to our sponsors and partners that help make AdaHack possible.



Jane Street

Optiver 



Hackathons 

Welcome Talk

Fiona McNeill

- Has Personal Chair in Computing Education in the School of Informatics
- Focuses on computing and STEM education, especially for women and young people from disadvantaged background
- Chairs the BCS Scottish Computing Education Committee



Safety Talk

Please pay attention to the important safety information

- Fire escape routes
- If a fire is suspected, use the break glass point
- Muster point is across the road at the corner of George Square Gardens
- No fire drill is scheduled for the day
- Toilets and water fountains are available nearby
- Do not go upstairs, it is out of bounds for AdaHack participants

If you need help or attention (e.g. there's a spill, First Aid needed), please speak to someone with a lanyard.

Schedule

08:30 Check-In + team and table allocation

09:15 Opening presentation & briefs explained

09:45 Coding begins!

13:00 LUNCH

13:30 Cup Stacking

18:15 Final submission deadline

18:30 First round of judging starts

19:30 DINNER

19:45 Second round of judging ends

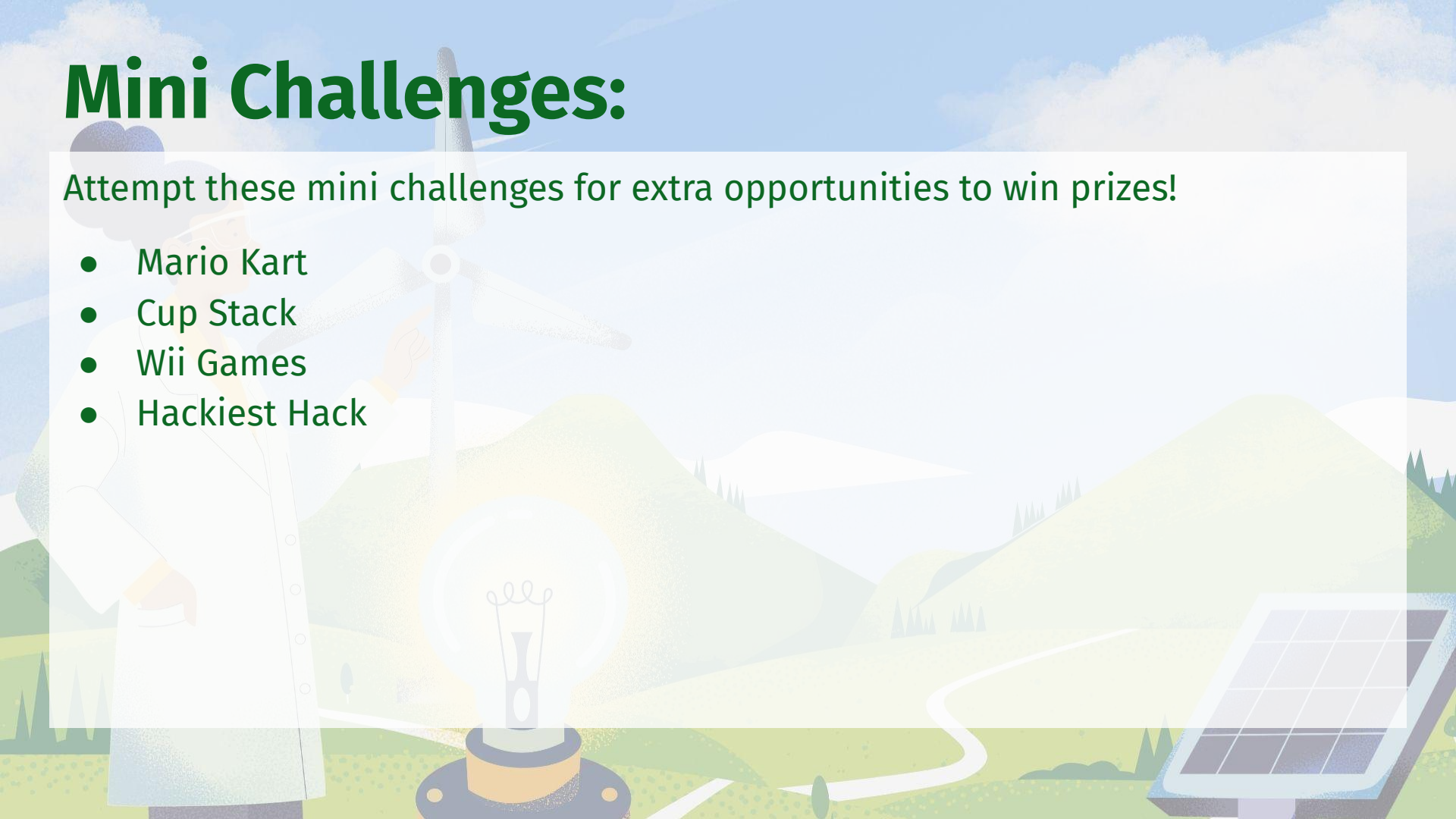
20:15 Closing presentation and prizes

21:00 END

Mini Challenges:

Attempt these mini challenges for extra opportunities to win prizes!

- Mario Kart
- Cup Stack
- Wii Games
- Hackiest Hack



Challenges:

Our challenges are meant to be open ended to encourage creativity, new ideas, and thinking outside the box. There is no right or wrong answer.

Challenge 1 - Hoppers (Easy): University of Edinburgh Sustainability

Challenge 2 - Hoppers (Hard): Sustainable Development Goals in Edinburgh

Challenge 3 - Jane Street: Making Jane Street Workers Commute More Sustainable

Challenge 4 - G-Research: Financial Performance and Environmental Impact

Challenge 5 - Optiver: Diversify Carbon Portfolio

Challenge 6 - People's Postcode Lottery: Keep your area Green

Challenge 7 - CompSoc: Identify Environmental Disasters

Challenge 1 - Hoppers (Easy)

Challenge: Choose one of the University of Edinburgh's actions from their sustainability website or report archives and design a website, game, or some other way to educate people on it.

Consider your target audience that you want to educate, which issue is most important for them to understand, and what different methods you can use to present information to them?

Helpful links: [UofE Sustainability Page](#), [UNESCO Sustainability Education Page](#)

Prize: A keyboard per team member

Challenge 2 - Hoppers (Hard)

Challenge: Consider the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals. Using the Scottish Government's data, figure out a way to apply these goals to solve a sustainability issue in Edinburgh.

Consider which issues are most prevalent in your own life in Edinburgh. How quickly do you want these to be fixed? How much would they cost, and where would the funding come from?

Helpful Links: Scottish Index of Multiple Deprivation, Climate Action in Edinburgh

Prize: Pair of Headphones per team member

Challenge 3 – Jane Street

Challenge: Consider the fact that Jane Street workers usually travel by car. Make a program that encourages workers to take an alternative and more sustainable route to the office.

Consider how you would convince workers to take this alternative route. Why is it appealing to them? Why is it important and why should they care? Explore the change in carbon footprint created by using car vs an alternative route. How can you improve this other route to make it more appealing to workers?

Helpful Links: [UMich Carbon Footprint Factsheet](#)

Prize: A speaker and Jane Street Water Bottle per team member

Challenge 4 - G-Research

Challenge: How can businesses grow sustainably without sacrificing profitability? Design and develop a programme that helps established businesses and emerging ventures quantify their carbon footprint, explore alternative business strategies, and identify the optimal balance between financial performance and environmental impact.

Helpful Links: [UK Company Reporting Greenhouse Gas Emissions](#)

Prize: £25 Voucher to and a speaker per team member

Challenge 5 - Optiver

Challenge: Build a carbon credit portfolio that delivers 100,000 of CO2 e on a budget and survives the unexpected. Try to minimize carbon emissions.

Helpful Links: [Climate Trace Data Downloads](#), [European Environment Agency Datahub](#), [GitHub yfinance](#)

Prize: A speaker & 1-1 Virtual Coffee Chat with Optiver per team member

Challenge 6 - Postcode Lottery

Challenge: Design and build something that helps neighbours keep their postcode area green. Show them what's happening where they live: the air, the green space, the local electricity. Then give them a reason to act on it together. You can find all the causes that our players support at postcodelottery.co.uk/good-causes.

Stretch goal: make it work better the more of the street joins in.

Prize: £70 **Lifestyle** gift card per team member

Challenge 7 - CompSoc

Challenge: Use open source imaging and sensor data to identify environmental disasters and anomalies as they occur. Bonus points for small-compute solutions that avoid the use of large models or make efficient use of pre-existing (non-language) models in novel ways.

Prize: Raspberry Pi per team member

Judging Criteria

If judges suspect reliance on AI, points may be deducted accordingly. While there is no zero-tolerance policy, the use of AI is discouraged.

MARKING POINT:	MAX SCORE:
Teamwork How much did each person contribute? How well did they work together?	10
Originality Was it original? Did they make it their own? Personality?	10
Theme How well did their project fit the theme of Sustainability?	10
Presentation Skills What was their final presentation? Was it concise and informative? Were they confident in their work? How well did they explain how their project worked?	10
Project Quality How good was their overall project? Was their idea good? Think of code and other technical aspects	20
<u>TOTAL</u>	60

Important Links:

[AdaHack 2026 Website](#)



[Event Discord](#)



[Submission Website](#)



